

E015

Project Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A credit union with 14 branches has an IT team that recently won an internal award. The team runs nightly backups, applies monthly security patches, staffs the help desk, and is implementing a new loan-origination system due in June. Which of these is a project?

- A. Implementing the new loan-origination system by June.
- B. Running nightly backups.
- C. Applying monthly security patches.
- D. Staffing the award-winning help desk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Midway through a project, a long-time client contact asks a developer directly to add a new report. The developer estimates it would take about two days. What should happen?

- A. Add it now and update the plan afterward.
- B. Let the developer add it, since it is only two days.
- C. Log a change request, analyze its impact, and get approval before work starts.
- D. Reject it, because scope can never change after planning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Activity A (3 days) must finish before B (4 days) and C (6 days) can start. Both B and C must finish before D (2 days). Activity C is assigned to the most experienced contractor. What is the project's minimum duration?

- A. 9 days
- B. 6 days
- C. 15 days
- D. 11 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A (3 days) precedes B (4 days) and C (6 days); both precede D (2 days). How much float does activity B have?

- A.** 11 days
- B.** 0 days
- C.** 2 days
- D.** 4 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A project sponsor in the London office reviews status in the team's cloud project tool. Planned value is \$50,000, earned value is \$40,000, and actual cost is \$45,000. What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

- A.** 0.90; the project is over budget.
- B.** About 1.13; the project is under budget.
- C.** 0.80; the project is over budget.
- D.** About 0.89; the project is over budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Planned value is \$50,000, earned value is \$40,000, and actual cost is \$45,000. What is the schedule performance index?

- A.** About 1.11; ahead of schedule.
- B.** About 0.89; behind schedule.
- C.** 0.80; behind schedule.
- D.** 1.25; ahead of schedule.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

The CFO, who has been with the company 18 years and prefers morning meetings, can cancel the project's funding but has little interest in its day-to-day details. How should the project manager engage her?

- A. Keep satisfied.
- B. Monitor.
- C. Keep informed.
- D. Manage closely.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A project team has 10 members, two of whom work remotely from another time zone. How many communication channels exist?

- A. 10
- B. 45
- C. 36
- D. 90

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team grows from 6 to 10 members. How many communication channels are added?

- A. 4
- B. 15
- C. 45
- D. 30

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A \$2.3 million project will house equipment at a site built in 1985 that is at risk of flooding. The project manager buys an insurance policy that pays for any flood damage. Which risk response is this?

- A. Avoid.
- B. Transfer.
- C. Accept.
- D. Mitigate.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project depends on one senior developer who might leave. Which action is mitigation of that risk?

- A.** Cross-train a second developer on the critical code.
- B.** Buy key-person insurance.
- C.** Record the risk and take no action.
- D.** Drop the features that need that developer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A PMP-certified project manager is assigned to a \$1.2 million project. Before planning, she needs formal authority to assign staff from three departments. Which document provides it?

- A.** Her PMP certification.
- B.** The project charter issued by the sponsor.
- C.** The project management plan.
- D.** The work breakdown structure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A credit union with 14 branches has an IT team that recently won an internal award. The team runs nightly backups, applies monthly security patches, staffs the help desk, and is implementing a new loan-origination system due in June. Which of these is a project?

Target word: identify the project **Decides:** Temporary with a unique result.

A	Correct	It has a defined end and a unique deliverable.
B	Confusion set	Ongoing, repetitive work is operations.
C	Adjacent category	A recurring cycle, not a one-time effort.
D	Camouflage	The award does not make ongoing support a project.

2. Answer C Concept 2

Midway through a project, a long-time client contact asks a developer directly to add a new report. The developer estimates it would take about two days. What should happen?

Target word: handling a scope request **Decides:** Any scope change goes through change control.

A	Inverted operation	Approval must come before the work.
B	Camouflage	Size does not exempt a change from control; this is scope creep.
C	Correct	Integrated change control protects scope, schedule, and budget.
D	Absolute language	Changes are allowed through the proper process.

3. Answer D Concept 3

Activity A (3 days) must finish before B (4 days) and C (6 days) can start. Both B and C must finish before D (2 days). Activity C is assigned to the most experienced contractor. What is the project's minimum duration?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** Longest path: A-C-D = 3 + 6 + 2 = 11.

A	Inverted operation	Uses the shortest path, A-B-D.
B	Wrong stem number	The longest single activity, not a path.
C	Confusion set	Adds every activity, ignoring that B and C run in parallel.
D	Correct	A-C-D is the longest path, so it is critical.

4. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A (3 days) precedes B (4 days) and C (6 days); both precede D (2 days). How much float does activity B have?

Target word: float on a non-critical activity **Decides:** Critical path 11 vs. path through B 9.

A	Wrong stem number	The project duration.
B	Confusion set	Treats B as if it were on the critical path.
C	Correct	11 – 9 = 2 days B can slip without delaying the project.
D	Adjacent category	B's duration, not its float.

5. Answer D Concept 4

~~A project sponsor in the London office reviews status in the team's cloud project tool.~~ Planned value is \$50,000, earned value is \$40,000, and actual cost is \$45,000. What is the cost performance index, and what does it mean?

Target word: CPI and meaning **Decides:** $CPI = EV / AC$.

A	Adjacent category	Divides AC by PV, which is not an EVM index.
B	Inverted operation	Divides AC by EV.
C	Confusion set	That is SPI (EV / PV).
D	Correct	$\$40,000 / \$45,000 \approx 0.89$, below 1.0.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Planned value is \$50,000, earned value is \$40,000, and actual cost is \$45,000. What is the schedule performance index?

Target word: SPI **Decides:** $SPI = EV / PV$.

A	Adjacent category	Divides PV by AC, which is not an EVM index.
B	Confusion set	That is CPI.
C	Correct	$\$40,000 / \$50,000 = 0.80$.
D	Inverted operation	Divides PV by EV.

7. Answer A Concept 5

~~The CFO, who has been with the company 18 years and prefers morning meetings,~~ can cancel the project's funding but has little interest in its day-to-day details. How should the project manager engage her?

Target word: grid strategy **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Correct	High power with low interest calls for meeting her needs without over-communicating.
B	Confusion set	For low power and low interest.
C	Inverted operation	For low power and high interest — the opposite profile.
D	Adjacent category	For high power and high interest.

8. Answer B Concept 6

~~A project team has 10 members, two of whom work remotely from another time zone.~~ How many communication channels exist?

Target word: channel count **Decides:** $n(n - 1) / 2$ with $n = 10$.

A	Wrong stem number	The headcount, not the channels.
B	Correct	$10 \times 9 / 2 = 45$.
C	Confusion set	Uses $n = 9$, leaving out one member.
D	Dropped element	Forgets to divide by 2.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

A team grows from 6 to 10 members. How many communication channels are added?

Target word: change in channels **Decides:** 45 – 15.

A	Wrong stem number	The number of people added.
B	Confusion set	The original channel count.
C	Dropped element	The new total; drops the starting 15.
D	Correct	10 people: 45 channels; 6 people: 15; 45 – 15 = 30.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A ~~\$2.3 million~~ project will house equipment at a site ~~built in 1985~~ that is at risk of flooding. The project manager buys an insurance policy that pays for any flood damage. Which risk response is this?

Target word: name the response **Decides:** Financial impact shifts to the insurer.

A	Confusion set	Avoidance would change the plan, such as using a different site.
B	Correct	Insurance shifts the impact to a third party.
C	Inverted operation	Acceptance takes no action to shift or reduce the threat.
D	Adjacent category	Mitigation lowers probability or impact, such as raising equipment off the floor.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A project depends on one senior developer who might leave. Which action is mitigation of that risk?

Target word: pick the action for a named strategy — reverse direction **Decides:** Mitigation reduces probability or impact.

A	Correct	Reduces the impact if the developer leaves.
B	Adjacent category	That is transfer.
C	Confusion set	That is passive acceptance.
D	Inverted operation	Changing the plan to remove the threat is avoidance.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A ~~PMP-certified~~ project manager is assigned to a ~~\$1.2 million~~ project. Before planning, she needs formal authority to assign staff from three departments. Which document provides it?

Target word: source of PM authority **Decides:** Formal authorization at initiation.

A	Camouflage	A credential shows knowledge, not authority on this project.
B	Correct	The charter authorizes the project and the PM's use of resources.
C	Adjacent category	Created during planning, after authorization.
D	Confusion set	Breaks down scope; it grants no authority.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	1	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Projects vs. operations	A project is temporary and creates a unique result; operations are ongoing and repetitive.	Calling any important or large work a project.	A defined end date and a one-time deliverable.
2	Integrated change control	Scope changes go through a formal change request, impact analysis, and approval before work begins.	Adding “small” requests directly, or refusing all change.	A stakeholder asks a team member for something new mid-project.
3	Critical path and float	The critical path is the longest path through the network and sets project duration; activities on it have zero float.	Picking the shortest path or summing every activity.	An activity network with parallel paths.
4	Earned value indexes	$CPI = EV / AC$ (cost efficiency); $SPI = EV / PV$ (schedule efficiency); below 1.0 is unfavorable.	Swapping numerator and denominator or mixing up CPI and SPI.	PV, EV, and AC given together.
5	Power/interest grid	High power-high interest: manage closely; high power-low interest: keep satisfied; low power-high interest: keep informed; low-low: monitor.	Mixing up keep satisfied and keep informed.	A stakeholder described by influence and level of interest.
6	Communication channels	$Channels = n(n - 1) / 2$ for n people.	Forgetting to divide by 2 or using the headcount itself.	Team size, especially a change in size.
7	Threat response strategies	Avoid removes the threat by changing the plan; transfer shifts impact to a third party; mitigate reduces probability or impact; accept acknowledges it.	Calling insurance mitigation or calling cross-training transfer.	An action taken about a named risk.
8	Project charter	The charter, issued by the sponsor, formally authorizes the project and gives the project manager authority to use resources.	Thinking the management plan or a certification grants authority.	“What gives the PM authority?” early in the project.

Course scope (public description): Project Management introduces students to the essential concepts of project management and the role of the project manager. Students learn to develop a project management plan across all project management standardized phases. Although the course takes into consideration the content areas of the Certified Associate in Project Management (CAPM) exam, this revised version of the course asks students to deliver performance assessments; it does not directly ask students to practice in the same modality as the objective CAPM exam. There are no prerequisites for this course.